in deep chagrin.' The priest got his wish not long after his return to Goa from Akbar's court, when he was lynched by a mob in Cuncolim. About two centuries later, in 1893, the single-mindedly pious Rudolf also got his due: he was beatified.

. Azfar Moin, *The Millennial Sovereign: Sacred Kingship & Sainthood in Islam* (Columbia University Press, 2012).

. Fr. Pierre Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits: An Account of the Jesuit Missions to the Court of Akbar*, trans. C.H. Payne (First published 1926; Low Price Publications, 2008).

. *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1.

. Arif Qandahari quoted in Irfan Habib, 'Akbar and Technology', in *Akbar and His India*, ed. Irfan Habib (Oxford University Press, 1997).

. *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1. Abul Fazl is not the only one to vouch for the purity of Akbar's coinage. A later and far more critical historian, Vincent Smith, too, writes that 'Akbar deserves high credit for the excellence of his extremely varied coinage, as regards purity of metal, fullness of weight, and artistic execution. The Mogul coinage, when compared with that of Queen Elizabeth or other contemporary sovereigns in Europe, must be pronounced far superior on the whole. Akbar and his successors seem never to have yielded to the temptation of debasing the coinage in either weight or purity. The gold in many of Akbar's coins is believed to be practically pure.' Vincent A. Smith, *Akbar the Great Mogul, 1542–1605* (Clarendon Press, 1917).

. *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1.

. Ibid.

. Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*.

. *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1. For all the curiosity, rationality and debate that filled this pre-modern world, its mysteries were not yet undone by science. Abul Fazl's description of the origins of amber is a lovely example of how rational explanation could coexist with magic in the sixteenth century. Thus, he writes: 'It is said that on some mountains a great deal of honey is to be found, so much in fact that it runs into the sea; the wax rises to the surface, when the heat of the sun reduces it to a solid state.' Honey comes from bees, which make it from scented flowers, Abul Fazl goes on. Therefore, amber is naturally scented – and sometimes bees are trapped in it.

. Habib, 'Akbar and Technology', in *Akbar and His India*.

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. Ibid., The export of horses, on the other hand, was forbidden, as Heinrich Blochmann notes in the *Ain-i-Akbari* (vol. 1). Horses were not native to Hindustan but were of great value to its armies. 'Droves after droves' of them were imported from Iran and Turan, writes Abul Fazl in the *Ain-i-Akbari* – at the time of his writing, there were 12,000 horses in Akbar's own stables. Amongst the men employed to take care of them was the '*sipandzoz*', whose job was to light sipand, rue, to keep the evil eye away from the prized animals. See Abu'l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1.

. 'It became the current custom,' writes Badauni, despairingly, '. . . to wear the rakhi on the wrist, which means an amulet formed out of twisted linen rags.' See Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*.

. 'Urdu' was the Turki word for 'camp' and etymological origin of the English word 'horde' (translator's note in *The Commentary of Father Monserrate*). Now, it is the name of an Indian language that grew from the mingling of many tongues in such camps.

. 'Camels are as nimble and skilful in a battle, if I may say so, as horses,' writes Monserrate. 'Nor are they less fierce. They fight with teeth and feet. If they catch hold of any one, they kneel upon him so